



CODEALPHA CYBER SECURITY INTERNSHIP • TASK 2

Phishing Awareness Training

Think Before You Click

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A frontline defense briefing on recognizing, avoiding, and reporting phishing attacks.



What is Phishing?

Phishing is a cyber attack in which attackers impersonate a trusted person, organization, or service to trick users into revealing sensitive information or performing an unsafe action.

COMMON TARGETS

- Passwords & login credentials
- Banking / card information
- OTPs & verification codes
- Personal information
- Sensitive documents

COMMON CHANNELS



Email



SMS



Phone Calls



Social Media

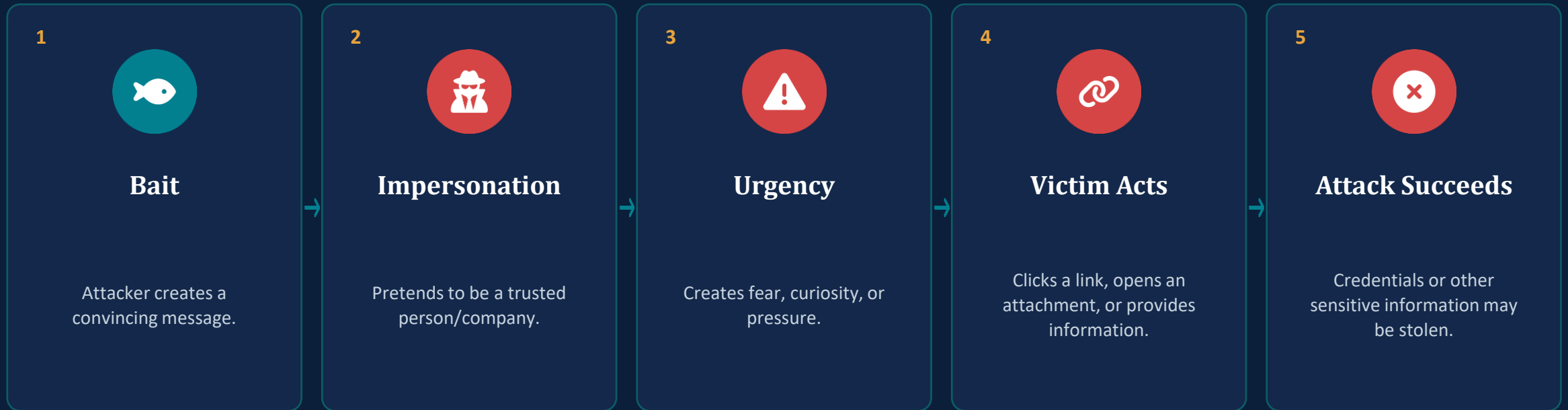


Fake Websites

Phishing attacks exploit human trust and behavior.



How Does a Phishing Attack Work?



STOP → CHECK → VERIFY → ACT



How to Recognize a Phishing Email

▶ COMMON RED FLAGS

- Suspicious or unfamiliar sender address
- Urgent or threatening language
- Unexpected attachments
- Suspicious links
- Requests for passwords, OTPs or financial info
- Spelling/grammar inconsistencies
- Generic greetings such as "Dear Customer"
- Offers that seem too good to be true



EXAMPLE MESSAGE

"Your account will be permanently suspended. Verify within 30 minutes."

Urgency + Threat + Suspicious Link = Major Warning Signs



DETECTION

Fake Websites & Suspicious URLs

Attackers often create websites that look almost identical to legitimate websites.

CHECK FOR

- Misspelled domain names
- Extra or unusual words
- Strange subdomains
- Random characters
- Unexpected login pages
- Suspicious pop-ups
- Requests for OTP / PIN / password

EXAMPLE URLS



paypa1.com



paypal.com.login-example.com



Always verify the actual domain



HTTPS does NOT automatically mean a website is legitimate.



Social Engineering & Types of Phishing

SOCIAL ENGINEERING TACTICS

Attackers manipulate emotions and trust to influence victims.



Urgency

"Act immediately!"



Fear

"Your account will be blocked."



Reward

"You won a prize!"



Impersonation

Pretending to be a trusted person.



Authority

Pretending to be bank, IT, HR, etc.

TYPES OF PHISHING



Phishing

Mass fraudulent messages



Spear Phishing

Targeted attacks



Whaling

Targets executives / high-value individuals



Smishing

SMS-based phishing



Vishing

Voice-call phishing



CASE STUDY

Twitter Account Takeover — 2020



2020

*High-profile accounts compromised via
social engineering*

In 2020, attackers used **social engineering** to target Twitter employees.

The attackers gained access to internal tools and compromised several high-profile accounts.

WHAT CAN WE LEARN?

- ✓ People can be targeted even when technical security exists.
- ✓ Social engineering can be highly effective.
- ✓ Employee security awareness is important.
- ✓ Unexpected requests should always be verified.



Cybersecurity is not only about technology — people are part of the security boundary.



How to Protect Yourself

BEFORE CLICKING

-  Check the sender
-  Inspect links before opening
-  Verify the domain
-  Be suspicious of urgency
-  Don't open unexpected attachments

PROTECT YOUR ACCOUNTS

-  Use strong, unique passwords
-  Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)
-  Keep software updated
-  Use a password manager where appropriate



GOLDEN RULE: *When in doubt, verify through an official channel.*



What If You Fall for Phishing?

Act Quickly — Don't Panic

1



Stop

Stop interacting with the suspicious page.

2



Change your password

If you entered your credentials.

3



Enable MFA

If it isn't already enabled.

4



Contact the organization

Through its official website / contact number.

5



Report the incident

To your IT/security team or relevant platform.

6



Monitor your account

For suspicious activity.

Early reporting can reduce the damage.



Interactive Phishing Quiz



QUESTION 1

You receive:

"Your bank account will be closed in 30 minutes. Click here to verify."

- A. Click immediately
- B. Reply with your details
- C. Open the bank's official website separately and verify
- D. Forward the message to friends

✓ Correct Answer: C

QUESTION 2

Which is a common phishing warning sign?

- A. Unexpected urgency
- B. Suspicious sender
- C. Unusual link
- D. All of the above

✓ Correct Answer: D



Remember

STOP · CHECK · VERIFY · PROTECT · REPORT



STOP

Don't react immediately.



CHECK

Inspect the sender and link.



VERIFY

Confirm requests through
official channels.



PROTECT

Use strong passwords + MFA.



REPORT

Report suspicious messages
or incidents.

Think Before You Click.

A few seconds of caution can prevent a serious security incident.

Thank You 

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship — Task 2

